

Advent Calendar — Quickstart

Add the metaobject-driven advent calendar section to an **existing** Shopify theme. Happy path, by hand in the Admin. Full reference: `INTEGRATION.md`.

Before you start

- A staff account with access to **Settings** → **Custom data** (metaobjects) and **Online Store** → **Themes**.
- The theme you will edit — duplicate it first (*Themes* → ... → *Duplicate*) so you work on a copy, then publish when happy.
- The `shopify-advent-calendar/` folder from this project. Only four subfolders go into the theme: `sections/`, `snippets/`, `assets/`, `locales/`.

1 • Add the section files to the theme

Online Store → **Themes** → ... → **Edit code** on your working copy. Add each file below with *Add a new section / snippet / asset* and paste its contents from `shopify-advent-calendar/<folder>/<file>`.

In the theme	Files to add
<code>sections/</code>	<code>advent-calendar.liquid</code>
<code>snippets/</code>	<code>advent-door.liquid</code> , <code>advent-overlay.liquid</code> , <code>advent-grid-defaults.liquid</code> , <code>advent-motif.liquid</code> , <code>advent-snow.liquid</code>
<code>assets/</code>	<code>advent-calendar.css</code> , <code>advent-calendar.helpers.js</code> , <code>advent-calendar.js</code>
<code>locales/</code>	<code>en.default.json</code> , <code>en.default.schema.json</code>

Locales: your theme almost certainly already has `en.default.json` and `en.default.schema.json`. Do *not* overwrite them — open each, and merge in the single key:

```
{ "sections": { "advent_calendar": { "no_entry": "Select an Advent calendar entry in the section settings." } } }
```

Both files can carry the same key.

FASTER ALTERNATIVE With Shopify CLI: `shopify theme push --theme <id> --only`

`"sections/advent-calendar.liquid" --only "snippets/advent-*" --only "assets/advent-calendar.*" --only "locales/*"`. Never push the whole folder over a live theme.

2 • Create metaobject definition — `advent_calendar_day`

Settings → **Custom data** → **Metaobjects** → **Add definition**. Name it **Advent Calendar Day**; confirm the type handle is exactly `advent_calendar_day`. Add these fields (the key must match exactly):

Key	Type	Required	Validation
<code>day</code>	Integer	Yes	min 1, max 25
<code>title</code>	Single line text	Yes	—
<code>message</code>	Rich text	Yes	—
<code>code</code>	Single line text	No	—
<code>motif</code>	Single line text	No	Preset choices (10, below)
<code>image</code>	File	No	Images only
<code>link_url</code>	URL	No	—
<code>link_label</code>	Single line text	No	—
<code>grid_area</code>	Single line text	No	— (layout override, step 7)
<code>grid_area_mobile</code>	Single line text	No	—

`motif` preset choices, exactly these ten, in order: `wreath`, `candle`, `star`, `gift`, `tree`, `bell`, `snowflake`, `stocking`, `bauble`, `candycane`. Empty / unknown falls back to `wreath`. There is deliberately no `size` field — a door's size is the two `span` values inside `grid_area`.

3 · Create metaobject definition — `advent_calendar`

Add definition → name **Advent Calendar**, handle `advent_calendar`.

Key	Type	Required	Notes / default
<code>heading</code>	Single line text	Yes	—
<code>subheading</code>	Single line text	No	—
<code>background_type</code>	Single line text	No	preset choices <code>solid</code> / <code>gradient</code> / <code>image</code> ; empty = <code>solid</code>
<code>background_color</code>	Color	No	type <code>solid</code> . Default <code>#1c1613</code>
<code>gradient_color_start</code> , <code>gradient_color_end</code> , <code>gradient_angle</code>	Color, Color, Integer	No	type <code>gradient</code> (angle 0–360, default 160)
<code>background_image</code> , <code>background_image_dim</code>	File (image), Integer	No	type <code>image</code> ; dim % is a dark overlay for legibility (0–100, default 40)
<code>text_color</code>	Color	No	<code>#f6ede0</code>
<code>door_color</code>	Color	No	<code>#2a3d35</code>
<code>door_text_color</code>	Color	No	<code>#cfe3d4</code>
<code>accent_color</code>	Color	No	<code>#c9a24b</code>
<code>show_snow</code>	True / false	No	default <code>true</code>

Key	Type	Required	Notes / default
<code>start_date</code>	Date	No	door N opens on <code>start_date + (N-1)</code> days; empty → day N of December this year
<code>days</code>	Metaobject list	Yes	list of Advent Calendar Day entries

For `days` : add field → **Metaobject** → turn on *List of entries* → point the reference at the **Advent Calendar Day** definition.

4 · Turn on storefront access

For **both** definitions: open the definition → **Storefront access** (a.k.a. Access → Storefronts) → enable **Web**. Without this the section renders nothing.

5 · Create the 25 day entries + the parent

1. **Advent Calendar Day** → **Add entry**, once per day. Set `day` to the number, fill `title` , `motif` , `message` (type straight into the rich-text editor — plain paragraphs are fine), and `code` where wanted. Leave `grid_area` / `grid_area_mobile` empty to use the built-in mosaic. Set status **Active**. Use the default content below (ported from the React version) as a starting point, or write your own.
2. **Advent Calendar** → **Add entry**. Fill `heading` (+ any colours / `show_snow` / `start_date`). In `days` , add all 25 day entries **in order 1 → 25**. Status **Active**.

Do steps 2, 3 & 5 via API instead (optional)

Two Node scripts create the definitions and all 26 entries through the Admin GraphQL API — everything except adding the section to the theme. Verified against a live store.

1. **Custom app** in the store (*Settings* → *Apps and sales channels* → *Develop apps* → *Create an app*) with Admin API scopes `write_metaobject_definitions` , `write_metaobjects` , `read_metaobjects` . Install it, copy the **Admin API access token** (`shpat_...` — not the API key/secret).
2. **Give the scripts the credentials**. From `shopify-advent-calendar/` , either a `scripts/.env` file (read automatically, git-ignored):

```
cp scripts/.env.example scripts/.env
# edit scripts/.env:
#   SHOPIFY_STORE=your-store.myshopify.com    (host only, no https://)
#   SHOPIFY_ADMIN_TOKEN=shpat_...
```

or shell env vars (these win over `.env`) — PowerShell:

```
$env:SHOPIFY_STORE = "your-store.myshopify.com"
$env:SHOPIFY_ADMIN_TOKEN = "shpat_..."
```

3. Run (Node ≥ 18), from `shopify-advent-calendar/`:

```
npm run create-defs # creates advent_calendar_day, then advent_calendar
npm run seed        # upserts the 25 day entries + advent-calendar-default
```

Both are idempotent — `create-defs` printing `= ... already exists` is fine; `seed` upserts by handle (`advent-day-01...25` , `advent-calendar-default`), so re-running never duplicates. Entries are created **Active**. `seed` ends with `Done`. Pick this entry in the section settings.

This covers steps 2, 3 and 5 (storefront access is set on the definitions by the script — still confirm it in step 4). Then do steps 6–7. Full detail: `INTEGRATION.md` §6.

Default day content

The `image` , `link_url` and `link_label` fields are left empty. `grid_area` is empty on every day (the built-in mosaic places them).

Day	motif	title	code	message
1	wreath	Bem-vindo ao Advento	—	Vinte e cinco dias, vinte e cinco pequenas surpresas. Volta amanhã para abrir a porta seguinte.
2	star	Uma citação para hoje	—	"O maior presente que podes dar a alguém é o teu tempo." Oferece um bocadinho do teu hoje.
3	candycane	Playlist de Inverno	ADVENTO-03	Usa o código como nome de uma playlist partilhada e adiciona a primeira música.
4	gift	Gesto simples	—	Manda mensagem a alguém com quem não falas há algum tempo.
5	candle	Receita rápida	COZINHA-05	Chocolate quente: leite, cacau, um quadrado de chocolate negro e uma pitada de canela.
6	snowflake	Pausa de dez minutos	—	Fecha os olhos e respira fundo dez vezes. É a tua porta de hoje.
7	bauble	Desafio de gratidão	—	Escreve três coisas boas que te aconteceram esta semana.
8	gift	Código secreto	ADVENTO-08	Copia o código e guarda-o. No dia 25 vais precisar dele.
9	candle	Luz das velas	—	Acende uma vela ao jantar hoje. Muda tudo.
10	candle	Maratona de leitura	LEITURA-10	Escolhe um livro curto e lê-o até ao fim do mês.
11	bell	Chamada surpresa	—	Liga a um avô, a uma avó, ou a quem faça esse papel na tua vida.
12	star	Estrela de papel	ADVENTO-12	Procura "estrela de papel 3D" e faz uma para o topo da árvore.
13	bauble	Dia de doçura	—	Prova um doce de Natal que nunca tenhas experimentado.
14	snowflake	Carta ao futuro	—	Escreve uma nota para leres no dia 1 de janeiro.

Day	motif	title	code	message
15	bauble	Metade do caminho	ADVENTO-15	Já abriste quinze portas. Copia o código e celebra com quem estás.
16	tree	Caminhada ao frio	—	Vinte minutos lá fora, mesmo que esteja cinzento.
17	stocking	Cinema em casa	FILME-17	Clássico de Natal, luzes apagadas, telemóvel na outra sala.
18	tree	Arruma um cantinho	—	Escolhe uma gaveta e deixa-a melhor do que estava.
19	bell	Elogio anónimo	—	Deixa um elogio sincero a alguém, sem assinar.
20	stocking	Conta uma história	ADVENTO-20	Pergunta a alguém mais velho como era o Natal quando tinha a tua idade.
21	snowflake	Solstício de Inverno	—	A noite mais longa do ano. A partir de amanhã os dias voltam a crescer.
22	gift	Embrulha à mão	PRENDA-22	Um presente, papel simples, fio de cozinha e um raminho verde.
23	bell	Mesa posta	—	Ajuda a preparar a mesa da consoada, nem que seja só a dobrar guardanapos.
24	candle	Véspera	ADVENTO-24	Última porta antes do Natal. Copia o código e respira: chegaste.
25	tree	Feliz Natal	ADVENTO-08-12-15-20-24	Juntaste os códigos secretos. Aqui fica o teu prémio: um dia inteiro sem pressa nenhuma.

Parent entry (`advent_calendar`) defaults: **heading** "Calendário do Advento", **subheading** "Abre uma porta por dia até ao Natal", **background_type** `solid` , colours as in step 3, **show_snow** on, **start_date** empty.

6 • Add the section to the theme

1. **Online Store** → **Themes** → **Customize** on your working copy.
2. Pick a template (or a section group that accepts sections) → **Add section** → **"Advent calendar"**.
3. In the section settings, under **Content**, set **Advent calendar** to the parent entry from step 5. If the picker is missing on your theme version, use the *"...or entry handle"* text field and type the entry's handle (e.g. `advent-calendar-default`).
4. **Save**.

7 • Check it, then publish

- **Preview day** (section setting): set 1–25 to walk the doors through locked → today → past; `0` = real date.

- `?day=13` on the preview URL: client-side override to test outside December.
- Open a door → the overlay animates from it; Esc / clicking the backdrop closes it; opened doors are remembered per browser.
- **Layout tweaks:** to move or resize a door, set its `grid_area` to "`<row> / <col> / span <height> / span <width>`" (1-based; e.g. `1 / 5 / span 2 / span 1`). Turn on **Show layout guides** in the section settings to see holes / overlaps flagged. Grid size is fixed at 7×8 desktop / 4×14 mobile in the settings; if you change it, re-balance every door. Full table + rules: `INTEGRATION.md` §8.
- Colours: the section's *Style overrides* beat the metaobject colour fields, which beat the built-in defaults. Keep text-on-background and door-text-on-door at WCAG AA.
- Background: set `background_type` on the calendar entry to `solid`, `gradient`, or `image`; only that type's fields apply. For an image, raise `background_image_dim` until text is legible. Full detail: `INTEGRATION.md` §9.1.
- Custom door icons: pick another of the ten `motif` values, or add your own SVG / put an image on the door face — `INTEGRATION.md` §10.
- When it looks right: **Themes** → ... → **Publish** the working copy.

If something's wrong

Symptom	Check
Section shows "Select an Advent calendar entry..."	Step 6.3 — the Advent calendar setting (or handle fallback) is not pointing at the parent entry.
Section renders nothing / blank	Step 4 — storefront access not enabled on one or both definitions. Also confirm the parent entry and its 25 days are Active , not draft.
All doors locked in December	Expected before day 1, or if <code>start_date</code> is a future date. Use Preview day to check.
Wrong icon on a door	<code>motif</code> value must be one of the ten preset choices (step 2), lowercase. To add your own icon: <code>INTEGRATION.md</code> §10.
Doors overlap / gaps in the grid	A custom <code>grid_area</code> broke the tiling. Turn on Show layout guides ; clear the field to fall back to the default.
Theme editor didn't update after editing a metaobject	Metaobjects are a separate Admin screen — go back to Customize and refresh the preview.

Advent Calendar for Shopify · quickstart. Full reference: `shopify-advent-calendar/docs/INTEGRATION.md`.
 Regenerate this PDF from `quickstart.html` (see the comment at the top of that file).